

DEATH OF JOHN S. WEAD

RESPECTED CITIZEN OF PARIS
CALLED TO HIS REWARD.

DECEASED WAS NATIVE OF OHIO

Served His Country Well as a Soldier, Participating in Several of the Notable Battles of the War—Other Deaths.

John Steele Wead who died at 4:30 o'clock a. m., Wednesday at his home 502 North Central avenue, was born on a farm near Xenia, O., June 11, 1835. He was educated in the public schools of Xenia, and upon finishing the course and while still a very young man, he came to Illinois and engaged in business at Galesburg. Here he remained until about the time the civil war broke out when he removed to Coles county, and in August, 1861, at Kansas he enlisted with Co. E, 66th Ill. Vol. regiment. He was in three engagements: Mt. Zion, Mo.; Shiloh and Ft. Donelson, Tenn. At the last named place, through terrible exposure he lost his health and was soon discharged in June, 1862. John J. Stevenson of this city was in the same company.

Returning to Illinois and to Coles county, he met Miss Phebe Butler, also an Ohioan, and on Dec. 24, 1863, they were married at Charleston and came at once to Paris, where they went to housekeeping and Mr. Wead engaged again in business. Five children were born to the union, Olive Belle and Bessie Helen, who died in infancy; Dr. Scott, of Wyoming, Ill., and Misses Ella Elizabeth and Urith Lois, of this city. Just eleven months ago Mrs. Wead preceded her husband to the home beyond.

So reads the brief biography of a life, but it reveals nothing of the beauty of character which those who know us best can see. A man devoted to home and family, most conscientious and honest in all his dealings with his fellowmen, attending strictly to his own business; in everything, dependable, gentle, kind. In short possessed of all those traits that go to make up an ideal citizen, neighbor, friend, the sort for whom no courts were ever organized.

In his religious convictions Mr. Wead was a Methodist and the funeral obsequies were in chare of Rev. M. G. Coleman.